GDG Algiers ER Task 04: A Sponsor That Could Harm GDG's Image

Oct 21, 2026 · @ch

I would pause, verify the facts and decide together with the chapter leads; I would neither take the money straight away nor reject it on a rumor.

What I would do

1. **Hold.** I do not confirm, announce or accept any money yet. I tell the company we are completing our internal review, without mentioning the controversy.
2. **Verify.** I look for reliable sources: when it happened, whether it is confirmed or only an allegation, and whether the company has responded or fixed it.
3. **Assess.** I compare the issue with GDG Algiers' values and audience of students and young developers. A labour dispute, a greenwashing claim and harm to people are different levels of risk. ER does not decide alone; I take it to the chapter leads.
4. **Decide** between three outcomes:
   - **Proceed with safeguards** if the issue is unproven, minor or resolved: no title sponsorship, limited visibility, written terms and the right to withdraw.
   - **Delay** if it is unclear or ongoing: ask the company to respond and decide by a fixed date.
   - **Decline** if it is serious or ongoing, or conflicts with our values: refuse politely, without public accusation, and leave the door open.

Why I would make this decision

The ER guidelines say a partnership must not compromise the community's values, experience or reputation, and that money alone should not decide. The largest sponsorship ever also creates the largest dependence and exposure. At the same time, a quick background check is not proof, so rejecting immediately could be unfair and cost a good partner.

What solution or alternative I would propose

If the risk is acceptable but real, I would offer a smaller, controlled deal: in-kind or Bronze-level support, no title, no stage time and no naming of the event. If the risk is too high, I would close the gap with the next prospects on the ranked list so the event does not

depend on one sponsor, and offer to reconsider later if the situation is resolved.

What I would do differently in the future

I would run a vetting checklist before any outreach: news search, past controversies, values fit and conflicts, with a green, yellow or red rating reviewed by the team. I would limit how much of the budget any single sponsor can supply, add a clause that lets GDG withdraw if serious reputational issues arise, and keep a short decision log.